

The 10 most common investor objections, with crisp answers grounded in data.

1. "Code review tools already exist (Greptile, CodeRabbit). How are you different?"

We are not code review. We are code governance. Code review suggests changes. We create tamper-proof judgment receipts proving WHO approved WHAT and WHEN -- admissible in court. Different buyer (CISO, not dev lead), different budget line (compliance, not DevOps).

2. "You have no customers, no revenue, no pilots. Why should I invest?"

Andy Ellis (ex-CSO Akamai, Partner at YL Ventures) signed up on our landing page within 48 hours of launch -- unprompted. TD Bank's VP of Engineering responded to cold outreach asking about differentiators. Phil Venables (ex-CISO Google Cloud, Ballistic Ventures) independently asked DD questions. 4.8% cold response rate from unknown founders. Market pull at zero spend is the strongest signal at pre-seed.

3. "Microsoft/GitHub could just build this."

A proprietary company cannot build a credible governance standard -- would you trust Microsoft to audit Microsoft's code? Open-source core is structurally required for governance legitimacy, and incumbents cannot open-source without cannibalizing their platform economics.

4. "Your sales cycle is 3-6 months. That's long."

The free GitHub Action installs in 2 minutes and delivers value on the first PR. Starter tier at \$499/mo with 30-day free trial converts without a sales call. The 3-6 month cycle is for Team (\$2K) and Org (\$12K) -- by then the customer already has months of governance data proving value. Product-led, not sales-led.

5. "Open source means anyone can fork you."

They can fork the kernel, but they cannot fork the audit history. Once a company builds 6 months of tamper-proof governance records, switching costs are enormous. The open core IS the moat -- it drives adoption that locks in the paid tiers.

6. "AI governance is not a real category yet. You're creating a market."

We are not. DORA (already in effect), EU AI Act, SOC2, HIPAA -- these are existing compliance mandates. We are the first tool that generates court-admissible proof of compliance for AI-generated code changes. The market exists, the budget exists.

7. "How do you get to \$1B?"

7,000 customers at \$12K/month (Org tier). That is CrowdStrike scale. Our 97-99% margins mean every dollar of revenue is almost pure profit. Realistic Year 1: \$660K ARR from 30 Starter + 8 Team + 2 Org. Starter is the volume wedge that feeds Team/Org upgrades.

8. "Two founders, no sales team. How do you sell enterprise?"

\$1M raise buys 36 months of runway at \$27.5K/month burn. First 12 months: David sells, Igor builds. At 3 Org customers we are breakeven and hire a sales rep. AI-native operations (\$1K/month API budget) replace 3-4 FTEs worth of manual work.

9. "What's your moat? This seems replicable."

Five moats from the Seven Powers framework: (1) Counter-positioning -- incumbents cannot open-source their audit trail. (2) Switching costs -- audit history is sticky after 6 months. (3) Network effect -- every participant strengthens the governance standard. (4) Potential cornered resource -- exclusive partnership for model confidence scoring (provisional patents). (5) Process power -- AI-native compound automation loop.

10. "Managed services don't get tech multiples."

White-glove is 5% of revenue (Enterprise tier only). 95% is pure SaaS with 97-99% margins. We lead with Starter (\$499/mo self-serve), Team (\$2K), and Org (\$12K) -- managed service is upsell, not core model.

Preparation note: These answers are drilled and ready for live conversation. Every claim is backed by the financial model, competitive landscape analysis, and market signals documented in the accompanying package.